



Develop and implement operational policies

D1.HGE.CL7.14

D1.HGA.CL6.13

D2.TGA.CL6.10

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual

Project Base

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The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

The ASEAN Secretariat is based in Jakarta, Indonesia.

General Information on ASEAN appears online at the ASEAN Website: www.asean.org.

All text is produced by William Angliss Institute of TAFE for the ASEAN Project on “Toolbox Development for Tourism Labour Divisions for Travel Agencies and Tour Operations”.

This publication is supported by the Australian Government’s aid program through the ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II (AADCP II).

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File name: AM Develop and implement operational policies_291015

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering 'Remarks' as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of 'Written Questions' for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

"These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: DEVELOP AND IMPLEMENT OPERATIONAL POLICIES		NOMINAL HOURS: 60
UNIT NUMBER: D1.HGE.CL7.14 D1.HGA.CL6.13 D2.TGA.CL6.10		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to develop and implement operational policies in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA	UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE	
Element 1. Develop operational policies 1.1 Develop <i>operational policies</i> and <i>strategies</i> based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation 1.2 Develop scope and <i>objectives</i> of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback 1.3 Identify and <i>analyse internal and external factors</i> that may impact on the policy 1.4 Consult appropriate <i>stakeholders</i> during the development of the policy 1.5 Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies 1.6 Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative	Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to developing and implementing operational policies within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Front Office 2. Housekeeping 3. Food and Beverage Service 4. Food Production 5. Travel Agencies 6. Tour Operation The <i>operational policies</i> may relate to: • The environment • Products and services	

1.7 Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines 1.8 Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues Element 2. Administer and monitor operational policy 2.1 Implement and <i>evaluate</i> identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities 2.2 Monitor <i>performance indicators</i> 2.3 Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements 2.4 Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy Element 3. Conduct ongoing evaluation 3.1 <i>Review the operational policy</i> to assess effectiveness in the workplace 3.2 Monitor <i>performance</i> 3.3 Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly 3.4 Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management	• Training • Workplace relations • Finance • Asset management. <i>Strategies</i> may include: • Client development • Geographic expansion • Organisational growth • Service growth • Debt reduction • Income development. <i>Objectives</i> may include: • Sales figures • Revenues • Delivery times • Service standards • Client numbers • Sales figures and targets • Booking levels • Customer or staff feedback • Productivity gains.
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	<i>Analyse internal and external factors may relate to:</i> • Capabilities and resources: ▪ Human resources ▪ Financial resources ▪ Equipment capacity ▪ Staff skill levels ▪ Hours of operation ▪ Communication capabilities ▪ Location/position • Trends and developments in the marketplace: ▪ Economic ▪ Ecological/environmental ▪ Government activities ▪ Social and cultural ▪ Demographic ▪ Technology ▪ Industrial • Comparative market information: ▪ Best practice information ▪ Benchmarking ▪ Competitor information • Legal and ethical constraints: ▪ Legislation ▪ Regulation ▪ Codes of practice
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	▪ Cultural expectations and influences ▪ Social responsibilities, e.g. Protection of children, environmental issues. <i>Stakeholders</i> may include: • Customers • Employees • Government agencies • Owners • Suppliers • Strategic alliance partners. <i>Evaluate</i> may include • Key performance indicators • Gap analysis • Customer feedback • Compliance reports • Employee feedback. <i>Performance indicators</i> may include: • Sales • Return on investment • Customer service • Debt servicing costs.
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Review the operational policy may relate to:

- Quarterly reviews
- Business plan cycle
- Major events triggering a review, e.g. change in market-place.

Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- Understanding of the key planning concepts and techniques including the structure of operational policies and steps in the planning process
- Knowledge of current internal and external environments which impact on planning within the enterprise or industry sector
- Understanding of research skills sufficient to source and analyse a broad range of information on varying issues and from multiple sources
- Knowledge of legal issues that impact on enterprise operations as appropriate to the industry sector.

Linkages To Other Units

- Develop and implement business plans
- Plan and establish systems and procedures
- Prepare business documents
- Maintain financial standards and records
- Manage legal requirements for business compliance
- Manage physical assets and infrastructure
- Lead and manage people.

	Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Demonstrated ability to undertake detailed, thorough and appropriate analysis of both internal and external business environments to provide a sound basis for policy planning • Demonstrated ability to develop and implement integrated operational policies within a travel and hotel industry context • Demonstrated ability to perform across a range of situations that demonstrates knowledge, understanding and skill in implementing the principles and practices of developing and implementing operational policies • Demonstrated ability to collect and analyse financial performance information • Demonstrated ability to plan and forecast future trends • Demonstrated ability to schedule activities to meet milestones • Demonstrated ability to research data and trends. Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration of the ability to develop and implement operational policies in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area, job role and area of responsibility • Assessment must include project or work activities that allow the candidate to respond to multiple and varying workplace issues relevant to work area, job role and area of responsibility that allow the candidate to demonstrate knowledge and awareness of developing and implementing operational policies.
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Resource Implications

Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated commercial workplace environment in which operational policies can be implemented; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment.

Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Case studies
- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Oral and written questions
- Portfolio evidence
- Problem solving
- Role plays
- Third party reports completed by a supervisor
- Project and assignment work.

Key Competencies in this Unit

Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively

Level 2 = competence to manage tasks

Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating

	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	3	Identify and analyse competitive activity
	Communicating ideas and information	3	Express complex strategies in a clear and concise format
	Planning and organising activities	3	Coordinate stakeholder involvement in the planning process
	Working with others and in teams	3	Devise strategies to ensure team commitment to business strategies
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	2	Create financial projections and forecasts
	Solving problems	3	Adjust strategies to respond to severe and sudden budgetary constraints
	Using technology	2	Identify and analyse the optimum use of technology to achieve business objectives

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop and implement operational policies D1.HGE.CL7.14 D1.HGA.CL6.13 D2.TGA.CL6.10
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Describe a situation where you have monitored workplace needs and/or opportunities as the basis for formulating operational policies and strategies.	☐	☐
2. Use an industry example to illustrate the link that should exist between an operational policy and the goals of the organisation.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Give examples of internal and external factors you have analysed as impacting on the development of an operational policy.	☐	☐
4. Identify the stakeholders you have worked with when developing operational policies and explain the role of each.	☐	☐
5. Give me an example of an appropriate and financially-sound resource strategy you have developed to support an operational policy.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. With reference to an operational policy you have developed describe the administrative framework and systems created to support it.	☐	☐
7. Using an operational policy you developed explain how you communicated necessary priorities, responsibilities and timelines to relevant others.	☐	☐
8. Describe how you consulted with colleagues to prepare an evaluation system for operational policies you developed.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Use two examples of operational policies you have developed to illustrate how you implemented required actions in accordance with required priorities.	☐	☐
10. What performance indicators have you used to monitor operational policies? How did you conduct the monitoring activity?	☐	☐
11. What progress reports have you had to prepare relating to the implementation and monitoring of operational policies you have developed?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Describe a situation where monitoring of operational policies indicated a need for more resources. How did you identify this situation? How did you respond?	☐	☐
13. Explain what you did to review an operational policy you developed or were responsible for implementing or monitoring.	☐	☐
14. Use an operational policy to illustrate how you monitored the performance of the policy.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. Tell me of a case where you identified a problem with an operational policy and took action on the issue.	☐	☐
16. Describe a scenario where you have used the findings of reviews of operational policies to assist with planning and operational management.	☐	☐

Written questions

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Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. Provide a general context for an organisation involved in the development and implementation of operational policies.

2. Give ten characteristics generally applicable to operational policies.

3. Provide six examples of standard contents of a policy.

4. Identify six topics for which organisations may develop operational policies.

5. Describe four ways to monitor workplace need when determining need for operational policies and strategies.

6. In relation to an operational policy of an organisation, what does 'scope' refer to?

7. What does the acronym SMART stand for with reference to SMART objectives?

8. Identify four topics which might form the basis of policy objectives for an organisation.

9. What four factors does a SWOT analysis address? Which are 'internal' factors and which are 'external'?

10. What seven external factors does a STEEPLE analysis address?

11. Select one issue/topic/factor that may be identified in a SWOT analysis and explain how it may be regarded as a positive for one organisation yet a negative for another.

12. Identify six stakeholders who may be involved in the formulation of operational policies for an organisation.

13. Describe four points that a resource strategy for financial resources to support an operational policy might address.

14. Describe four points that a resource strategy for physical resources to support an operational policy might address.

15. Describe four points that a resource strategy for human resources to support an operational policy might address.

16. Identify six criteria which need to be addressed for a resource strategy to be deemed 'appropriate and financially-sound'.

17. In relation to operational policies for organisations, define 'infrastructure'.

18. Name four practical requirements necessary in order to create an effective administrative framework and systems capable of supporting a planned policy/initiative.

19. Describe four keys to communication of new (or revised) operational policies (or strategies or initiatives).

20. Name three strategies to follow when communicating policies to stakeholders/staff in an organisation.

21. Identify six reasons to evaluate operational policies.

22. List three procedures which may be used to evaluate operational policies.

23. Identify four key factors in relation to implementation of operational policies.

24. List six considerations when implementing new (or revised) operational workplace policies.

25. What is 'primary evaluation' in relation to the implementation and evaluation of operational policies?

26. Identify three 'timing' options for monitoring performance indicators of operational policies.

27. Describe four ways/practices which can be used to monitor key performance indicators of operational policies.

28. Give five basic requirements for reports on the implementation of operational policies.

29. Identify three options for sharing report information on the implementation of operational policies.

30. Describe four matters which may be highlighted in reports on the implementation of operational policies.

31. Give four reasons it is important to revise and adjust policies.

32. What are the two basic options for possible action in response to monitoring evidence/data regarding the operation/performance of operational policies?

33. Give four standard requirements regarding the review of operational policies.

34. Detail four issues/topics/areas which could or should be addressed when reviewing operational policies.

35. Give three aims of monitoring business performance in relation to the performance of operational policies.

36. Identify four points to consider when monitoring the performance of an operational policy on an ongoing basis.

37. Give four examples of action that may be taken in response to positive outcomes for operational policies.

38. Give four examples of action that may be taken in response to negative outcomes for operational policies.

39. List six standing requirements in relation to the incorporation of policy evaluation results into ongoing planning and operational management.

[illegible]

Answers to written questions

Develop and implement operational policies – D1.HGE.CL7.14
D1.HGA.CL6.13
D2.TGA.CL6.10

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. Provide a general context for an organisation involved in the development and implementation of operational policies.

Answer must address:

- The organisation has a formal set of plans – which may include:
 - A business plan
 - Strategic plans
 - Tactical plans
 - Operational plans
 - Contingency plans
- The policies of the organisation need to:
 - Reflect the plans which have been developed for the business
 - Flow directly from the plans
 - Support attainment of the goals and objectives identified in the plans
- The procedures of the organisation are:
 - Driven by the statements made in relevant policies
 - In accordance with policies
 - Directly linked to the public statements the organisation makes about itself (in terms of its Mission Statement, Vision Statement and Core Values statement).

2. Give ten characteristics generally applicable to operational policies.

- Flow from the plans of the business
- Represent the thinking/philosophy of the business
- Define the position of the organisation on a matter by giving insight into its stance and orientation on issues which are covered by the policy
- Are developed before procedures
- State the intention and expectations of the organisation and staff in relation to the subject that is the title of the policy
- Explain what the organisation wants to achieve
- Define and describe how the organisation (and, by extension, its employees) will act in given situations, if/when they arise
- Are the 'rules' the organisation seeks to operate by
- Give consistency in the way the organisation operates
- Contain a statement explaining the reason the policy has been prepared
- Provide guidance to employees about what the organisation wants – and how workers should act to help achieve that outcome
- Identify responsibilities for taking action to achieve the desired outcomes
- Prescribe timing considerations relevant to the issue
- Resolve anticipated problems in relation to the policy topic
- Identify documentation to be used or completed in relation to the topic, if/where necessary
- Contain information on legal and regulatory requirements the organisation must meet, if applicable
- Align with other public statements the organisation makes about itself
- Should be formalised by being *written* documents – rather than simply existing in the minds of management in order that:
 - There is no confusion about what they say
 - They can be readily shared among the workforce.

3. Provide six examples of standard contents of a policy.

- Name/title of the policy
- Purpose of the policy – explaining why the policy has been developed
- Scope of the policy – identifying who the policy applies to/who is bound by it
- Date the policy applies – the date the policy becomes/became effective
- Legislative authority – specifying statutes which govern implementation of the policy (if applicable – many operational are subject to legislation, and many are not)
- Policy statement/s – statement/s indicating:
 - How *this* policy fits with others and with the overall operation of the business
 - Relevant commitments by management to specifics of the policy
 - Description/s of processes inherent in implementing the policy
- Responsibilities for action – giving names/titles of those with specific responsibility under the policy in areas such as, for example:
 - Compliance
 - Monitoring
 - Review
 - Record management
 - Reporting
- Consequences of non-compliance
- Definitions – in relation to policy-specific terms
- Version control information.

4. Identify six topics for which organisations may develop operational policies.

- Environment
- Products and services
- Training
- Workplace relations
- Finance
- Asset management.

5. Describe four ways to monitor workplace need when determining need for operational policies and strategies.

- Encourage staff to identify areas for attention through a selection of communication and feedback mechanisms
- Assess actual business performance (KPIs) against projected outcomes
- Observe worker practice
- Conduct workplace inspections
- Analyse workplace accidents and incidents
- Evaluate feedback received from customers.

6. In relation to an operational policy of an organisation, what does 'scope' refer to?

Answer must address:

- 'Scope' refers to the limitations which apply to a policy.
- The scope of a policy therefore:
 - Defines its reach
 - Restricts its use
 - Prescribes the framework and context in which it is to be applied
- In practice the scope for a policy may be:
 - A named individual or nominated group of individuals – instead of *all* employees, persons or customers
 - A certain department or area of an organisation – instead of all workplace divisions
 - A specific office or agency of the organisation– instead of all physical locations
 - A stated time of the year – which may be described by dates or in some other industry-appropriate or industry-relevant manner
 - A geographic location – such as a given country, region or destination
 - Time-related – detailing times of the day when the policy applies, and times when it does not.

7. What does the acronym SMART stand for with reference to SMART objectives?

- S = Specific: the objectives must be clearly spelled out/described so there is no confusion
- M = Measurable: there must be some metric/way of measuring/quantifying progress towards/attainment of the objective
- A = Attainable (or Achievable): the target set must be something that can be done
- R = Realistic (or Relevant): the topic that is the focus of the policy must be something to which the organisation is committed and is genuinely committed to
- T = Time-related (or Tangible): there must be a finite timeframe attached.

8. Identify four topics which might form the basis of policy objectives for an organisation.

- Sales figures – in terms of units sold
- Revenues – in terms of money earned/generated
- Delivery times – which may refer to speed of delivery and the percentage of 'on time' deliveries
- Service standards – with reference to established criteria (as set by the organisation, or with reference to an industry benchmark or accepted industry standard) for each individual aspect of service delivery
- Client numbers – which may be classified in terms of (for example):
 - New customers; Repeat customers; Converted customers – that is, customers who transition from 'enquiries' into 'sales' or who move from 'prospects' to 'purchasers'
- Sales figures and targets – which can be specified by:
 - Product or service type; Name of individual staff member; Department or other physical location; Target market type, as defined by the business
- Booking levels – which can be stated with reference to:
 - Physical numbers; Specific products, services and/or target markets; Conversions; Percentage accompanied by advance/holding deposit; Refunds and withdrawals
- Customer feedback – which may be:
 - Separated into 'Compliments' and 'Criticisms'; Rated on a 'Customer Satisfaction' score/index
- Staff feedback – which is often classified:
 - By number; With reference to topic/focus of the feedback (management; operational issues; remunerations; working conditions)
- Productivity – measuring (in a useful way to the organisation) the relationship between inputs to the production process and the resulting outputs.

9. What four factors does a SWOT analysis address? Which are 'internal' factors and which are 'external'?

- Strengths and weaknesses – internal
- Opportunities and threats – external.

10. What seven external factors does a STEEPLE analysis address?

- Social factors
- Legal factors
- Economic factors
- Political factors
- Technological factors
- Environmental factors
- Ethical factors.

11. Select one issue/topic/factor that may be identified in a SWOT analysis and explain how it may be regarded as a positive for one organisation yet a negative for another.

No model answer.

12. Identify six stakeholders who may be involved in the formulation of operational policies for an organisation.

- Customers
- Employees
- Government agencies
- Owners
- Investors and shareholders
- Suppliers
- Strategic alliance partners.

13. Describe four points that a resource strategy for financial resources to support an operational policy might address.

- The total amount of money available for the project
- Contributions made by individual sources (consolidated funds, contributions by individual departments or offices/agencies, borrowings/loans, shareholders, government grants and similar
- Names of people – with:
 - Authority to access/spend the identified funds
 - Responsibility for monitoring and reporting
- Times which apply to use of the money – for example:
 - Dates when funds become available
 - Dates by which funds must be spent
- Limits regarding what money can be spent on
- Need for quotations to be obtained – for expenses over a given amount
- Requirement for money to be spent with ‘preferred suppliers/providers’ where possible.

14. Describe four points that a resource strategy for physical resources to support an operational policy might address.

- Types and quantities of resources available
- Location of resources
- Identification of resources which have been contributed by partners/external sources
- Where resources which need to be obtained can or must be sourced
- Specification of what is to happen with physical resources when the initiative is complete – for example, disposed of/thrown out, sold, given to charity, returned to XYZ
- Where and how certain resources may/must be used
- Monitoring of resource usage
- Accountability for usage.

15. Describe four points that a resource strategy for human resources to support an operational policy might address.

- Names of staff to be involved – or who have been allocated to the initiative
- Number of hours for each staff member – or each department/division
- Classification of employees – by:
 - Employment status
 - Job title/position
- A budget for staffing – which may be based on:
 - Hours
 - A monetary figure
 - A department/office contribution
 - Definition and treatment of relevant on costs
- Training available for nominated employees – in relation to the initiative
- Identification of new staff to be recruited
- Secondment of employees to the project
- Incentives/remuneration adjustments to be paid to those working on the initiative – where/if applicable (such as ‘higher duties’ payments)
- Considerations in relation to internal succession planning for the organisation
- Alignment of HR actions and decisions with umbrella HR plans.

16. Identify six criteria which need to be addressed for a resource strategy to be deemed ‘appropriate and financially-sound’.

- Have been approved by management
- Satisfy requirements of key stakeholders
- Provide suitable resources in sufficient quantities
- Are safe to use/implement
- Comply with all legislated obligations
- Align with company goals, objectives, higher-level plans and public statements
- Make resources available when needed
- Conform with budgetary limitations
- Have been subjected to required analysis – which may include:
 - Cost-Benefit analysis
 - ROI
- Have contingency plans developed for them.

17. In relation to operational policies for organisations, define 'infrastructure'.

Infrastructure in this context can be seen as:

- Systems necessary to support implementation of policies and initiatives
- Facilities required to enable required administrative work to be conducted for the policies and initiatives.

18. Name four practical requirements necessary in order to create an effective administrative framework and systems capable of supporting a planned policy/initiative.

- Identify and allocate roles for the initiative – so there is clarity regarding responsibilities for action required
- Determine documentation to be used – which may mean:
 - Developing new forms
 - Deciding on the use of existing internal paperwork
- Verify KPIs and planned objectives have been addressed – to ensure all aspects of the policy/initiative can be covered by administrative duties
- Implement relevant risk management – as appropriate to issues where this action is deemed necessary
- Prescribe reporting protocols – with reference to:
 - Timing of reports
 - Nature of the reporting mechanism/s
- Generate scopes of authority for policy-specific issues
- Train staff – in required practices as they apply to the initiative
- Ensure safety provisions – for all aspects of the project
- Decide on security protocols – to safeguard information captured/generated by administration
- Set up suitable data/information gathering options and procedures – to ensure all identified materials are captured and recorded
- Establish a viable communication plan – to exchange information between stakeholders
- Create a system for users and customers to provide feedback – if they:
 - Identify a problem or issue
 - Have a suggestion/recommendation to make.

19. Describe four keys to communication of new (or revised) operational policies (or strategies or initiatives).

- The communication must be planned – effective communication never ‘just happens’
- The communication method/medium preferred by the stakeholder should be used – to demonstrate respect for their stated preferences
- Communications should be pitched at the level of the recipient – to optimise likelihood of people reading and understanding what is being provided
- A track must be kept of those who are contacted – so a record of the communication is maintained and/or available
- Follow-up must occur – in situations where:
 - There is difficulty contacting a person
 - Questions/issues are raised
 - More information/explanation is requested.

20. Name three strategies to follow when communicating policies to stakeholders/staff in an organisation.

- Hold a formal meeting (or series of meetings) to inform stakeholders of the operational initiative – this could/should feature:
 - Verbal explanation PowerPoint; Hard copy handouts; A Q&A session
- Speak to key stakeholders on a one-on-one basis – to personalise the delivery and allow a more individualised approach.
 This may include face-to-face discussions with external and internal people, as appropriate to the nature of the policy/initiative
- Provide hard copy documents – without more formal contact, which may mean:
 - Mailing documents to recipients; Hand-delivering documents; Posting documents on restricted access intranet sites
- Use electronic options – where these have been indicated as a preferred communication option. Include attachments of documents as necessary.

21. Identify six reasons to evaluate operational policies.

- Determine their effectiveness
- Learn lessons which may be able to be transferred to other policies and/or other areas
- Maintain alignment with compliance obligations
- Demonstrate and discharge 'due diligence'
- Change ineffective policies so they become more effective
- Monitor responsibility and accountability issues relevant to the focus of the policy
- Avoid a situation where ineffective policies become entrenched as standard
- Decide the future for the policy – with options being:
 - Leave the policy 'as is'
 - Amend one or more aspects of the policy
 - Delete the policy from operational use.

22. List three procedures which may be used to evaluate operational policies.

- Analysing stories and anecdotal evidence regarding a range of issues such as:
 - Impact of the policy
 - Ease/difficulty in implementing aspects of it/all of it
 - Feedback received
- Developing and administering series of questions or a questionnaire – to elicit information on the factors deemed by the stakeholders to be important to the evaluation process
- Undertaking empirical analysis – which may feature:
 - Comparisons of quantifiable projected and actual data – as set out in the KPIs and objectives for the policy/initiative
 - Statistical manipulation – where certain data is manipulated to produce results deemed relevant for the purpose of the activity.

23. Identify four key factors in relation to implementation of operational policies.

- An implementation plan *may* be prepared – for the introduction/implementation of a policy.

This is SOP for the introduction/implementation of many workplace initiatives but **not so common** where policies are concerned unless they are *major* policies with *significant* expected impact across a very wide range of people and/or issues.

- A suitable and receptive environment needs to be created in the workplace – where:
 - Those impacted are well disposed to the initiative
 - People are made aware of an inclusive orientation to the introduction so they understand their opinions and feedback are sought and will be listened to
 - Effective procedures and protocols have been established where necessary to enable effective implementation of the policy
 - Everyone knows possible risks/problems have been identified and preparations taken to manage those situations
 - Management (not workers) is seen as accountable – but they are reliant on support and cooperation from others
- The policies *must* be **initially** implemented **totally** as planned – and as stated in the policy document.

If policies do not succeed ‘as planned’ it is important to know the fault lies with the policy and the way it was developed or written, and not in the way it was put into practice.
- Initial implementation must be monitored – to determine if immediate changes need to be made to the plans for implementation/the policy itself based on;
 - Issues arising/emerging
 - Obvious unintended and/or unforeseen consequences
- Corrective action needs to be taken when obvious need to do so is identified – as opposed to waiting for scheduled reviews and analysis which may be listed for weeks or months into the future.

24. List six considerations when implementing new (or revised) operational workplace policies.

- Have senior management make a public statement
- Ensure all resources (financial, physical, human and knowledge/information-based) are available
- Check all those impacted by the policy have been informed
- Adhere to the promised/projected schedule for implementation
- Be available to provide necessary and assistance
- Encourage adherence to the requirements of the policy
- Verify the policy is functionally compliant with all necessary related obligations
- Ensure required administrative activities are being undertaken in relation to the initiative
- Action is taken to create a workplace environment supportive of the change
- Engage with those who are to be impacted.

25. What is 'primary evaluation' in relation to the implementation and evaluation of operational policies?

'Primary evaluation' in this context refers to management activities undertaken to monitor the very first stages (hours, days, weeks) of a new policy.

26. Identify three 'timing' options for monitoring performance indicators of operational policies.

- In terms of a single month
- After several (two or three) months
- At a date identified in the plan for the operational policy.

27. Describe four ways/practices which can be used to monitor key performance indicators of operational policies.

- Discussing KPIs with key stakeholders
- Reviewing each KPI to ensure it is still accurate
- Reviewing 'required level of achievement' for each KPI
- Checking level of success against current KPI's
- Identifying reasons why KPI's have or have not been met
- Determine if KPIs need to be amended
- Making recommendations for changes where amendments are required.

28. Give five basic requirements for reports on the implementation of operational policies.

- Be fair and accurate – they must be truthful, telling the ‘bad’ as well as the ‘good’
- Be based on facts – as opposed to being based on supposition, opinion and ‘hope’
- Not be personal in nature – that is, they should not aim to be vindictive about a person/group of people
- Be produced and circulated by the date identified in the plan for implementation – each time the need for a report is mentioned

There can also be a need for:

- An Initial/Introductory report
- Interim report/s
- Final report
- Only be released for discussion to those who have been approved to receive them – usually this means only those designated on an authorised Distribution List, as these reports are often regarded as being Commercial in Confidence.

29. Identify three options for sharing report information on the implementation of operational policies.

- Holding team meetings and disseminating information at staff briefings – to share information within operational teams/workers
- Distributing hard copy information – to identified stakeholders
- Sharing information via the intranet – using ‘Password protected’ protocols to limit access only to nominated persons
- Providing formal face-to-face group presentations with stakeholders – supplemented by hard copy handouts, explanations and Q&A sessions.

30. Describe four matters which may be highlighted in reports on the implementation of operational policies.

- Explaining if the operational policy is working or not – and quantifying the outcome (if possible)
- Identifying the reasons why it is working or not working – drawing direct links between ‘cause and effect’
- Significant variations from KPIs/projections – and coverage of the factors associated with those variances changes
- Unusual results – and determination of their causes
- Strengths and opportunities – which have emerged from the initiative
- Weaknesses and potential areas for improvement – as indicated by the evidence captured
- Impact/implications of the results and conclusions – on projected future performance of the organisation.

31. Give four reasons it is important to revise and adjust policies.

- Factor in new and emerging information – which would simply not have been available when the original policy was written
- Maintain credibility with stakeholders – who will expect the organisation to be taking some action in response to implementation of a new or revised policy
- Align with internal obligations imposed on managers and/or management teams – most managers or management teams will be under a formal responsibility to take action as/where necessary to revise and adjust policies on the basis of evidence derives as a result of monitoring activities
- Exploit positive results – see below
- Minimise adverse impacts – see below
- Demonstrate responsible management – and discharge requirements relating to due diligence (if these requirements have not been specifically stipulated/spelled out by the organisation
- Prove ongoing engagement with the initiative and/or the policy – in a practical/hands-on way.

32. What are the two basic options for possible action in response to monitoring evidence/data regarding the operation/performance of operational policies?

- Do something
- Do nothing – doing nothing is a valid in response in some cases but it must be a considered and rational decision to do so and not just a default position because people cannot be bothered taking action.

33. Give four standard requirements regarding the review of operational policies.

- Reviewed at the date contained in the policy and set as the official review date – incorporation of this review date must be a mandatory part of the development of every policy
- Reviewed on some regular basis, regardless – such as:
 - Quarterly
 - Every six months
 - Annually
 - In synchronisation with the business plan cycle for the organisation
- Reviewed when there has been an event deemed to be ‘significant’ in nature – this may be:
 - An incident or accident (or near miss)
 - A serious complaint or other nominated occurrence
 - Legal action
 - A major change in marketplace
- Reviewed by suitable persons – generally:
 - Those involved in the development of the policy
 - Those impacted by the policy
- Reviewed and revised according to a pre-determined process/plan – this is a written plan detailing and/or providing guidelines or requirements in relation to:
 - The aspects of the policy to be evaluated and/or given special attention
 - When evaluations will take place
 - How the evaluation will be conducted
 - Who will be involved in conducting evaluations
 - Documents, data and/or organisations which need to be investigated/researched as part of the review process.

34. Detail four issues/topics/areas which could or should be addressed when reviewing operational policies.

- Feedback from staff and other users in relation to the policies
- Comments from customers impacted by the policy
- Extent of actual/genuine compliance with the policy
- Impact being noticed on topics and targets relevant to the policy
- Impact being noticed on expenditure/revenue/productivity.

35. Give three aims of monitoring business performance in relation to the performance of operational policies.

- Identifying policy areas which are adhered to/implemented as required or intended
- Rewarding and/or acknowledging compliant behaviour
- Identifying where areas of policy can be improved through:
 - Identification of problems
 - Understanding cause/s of issues
 - Finding suitable solutions to identified problems/issues
 - Generating a viable solution.

36. Identify four points to consider when monitoring the performance of an operational policy on an ongoing basis.

- Fact-based/real evidence **must** be generated as a result of the monitoring processes
- The monitoring process should be an **ongoing** process
- Definite responsibility must be allocated for monitoring activities
- Sufficient resources need to be provided
- Attention must be paid to obtaining 360° feedback
- Training may need to be provided to those who have responsibility for monitoring
- The context for the activity must be a foremost consideration
- The process should seek to produce two classifications of data
- The process should generate comparative data
- There *may* be a restriction on the number of policies which can be/have to be monitored
- Effort must be made to identify reasons for results which are generated
- The policy being monitored must be seen as part of 'the bigger picture'
- Records should be generated and maintained regarding the monitoring process
- The monitoring activity/activities are not an end in themselves.

37. Give four examples of action that may be taken in response to positive outcomes for operational policies.

- Reviewing and revising policies – to:
 - Create enhanced objectives supported by what the data says
 - Expand goals
 - Increase participants
 - Extend timelines and the timeframe for the policy
- Endorsing the *existing* policies – with a view to reproducing the previous results during the next monitoring/research cycle.
- This is acceptable where everyone is happy with things ‘as they are’ and do not want extra growth, revenue, productivity or other positive indicators
- Producing revised/enhanced targets for outcomes – seeking to increase results for the next/designated time period or milestone
- Continuing support for initiatives /elements which have generated these results – in terms of:
 - Funding
 - Moral support
 - Other resources
 - Providing extra staff and/or physical resources to support growth
 - Supplying more hours for personnel to demonstrate required compliance
 - Arranging for more or different physical resources
 - Changing the mix of employees involved in implementation
 - Altering supply protocols for physical resources
- Transferring lessons learned – as a result of these policies/initiatives to:
 - Other topics within the organisation
 - Other programs, proposals or initiatives
- Promoting success – by:
 - Celebrating with those who implement the policy and are responsible for its success
 - Congratulating personnel
 - Rewarding designated/key as/if deemed appropriate
- Developing associated policies – which:
 - Expand the focus of the *other policies* on the basis of lessons learned from *this policy*
 - Extend the scope of the initial policy – so its impacts and benefits are more widespread.

38. Give four examples of action that may be taken in response to negative outcomes for operational policies.

- Holding a formal enquiry into the outcomes – which should:
 - Involve those who implement the policy and are impacted by it
 - Include all stakeholders
 - Check/confirm/verify the conclusions
 - Evaluate/interrogate the analysis which has produced the negative outcome
- Conducting additional or different *research* – to:
 - Identify if results/outcomes are different
 - Determine if monitoring techniques/data collection is the reason for outcomes
- Undertaking different data *analysis* techniques – to:
 - See if the outcomes differ
 - See if previous results are confirmed
 - Confirm previous results **or** generate legitimate *alternative* data/outcomes
- Reviewing and revising policies – to:
 - Alter allocation of responsibilities of key persons especially where it is believed there is a demonstrable need to do so
 - Amend/reduce targets
 - Increase funding/resources – to help achieve initial targets
 - Reduce funding/resources – to reflect the reduced outcomes
 - Provide more time for objectives to be achieved
 - Include/upgrade risk management protocols relating to the policy
- Providing more training to participants
- Conducting more or different promotion of the policy
- Apologising and explaining the outcomes
- Accepting the outcomes and being satisfied with the less-than-expected results – in terms of:
 - Acknowledging the results which have been achieved are nonetheless beneficial despite failing to achieve the targets set
 - Understanding the impacts of the initiative were *starting* to become acceptable even though the positive expectations were not being achieved
- Abolishing the policy – and:
 - Considering an alternative policy
 - Waiting for a later/different time to re-introduce the original policy/initiative
 - Deciding, on balance, the benefits of trying to persist with the policy are not justified in terms of the negative outcomes which are being realised.

39. List six standing requirements in relation to the incorporation of policy evaluation results into ongoing planning and operational management.

- Must feature collaboration with relevant stakeholders
- Must be based on fact and the results of evidence-based analysis
- Need to generate an improvement to the current situation
- Must address identified need and/or deficiencies
- Have to be cost-effective
- Must be viable, legal and practical
- Must feature use of version control protocols to ensure correct version is being used at any point in time
- Must be approved by management prior to implementation.

40. Describe five actions which might be taken when incorporating results of policy evaluations into ongoing planning and operational management.

- Re-writing existing policies – to prepare ‘revised’ policies which address:
 - Previous errors or omissions; Identified policy gaps
- Circulating ‘draft’ for comment – prior to confirming them as endorsed
- Scrapping ‘old’ and/or unsatisfactory or un-workable policies - and writing new/replacement ones which may:
 - Address new issues; Feature benchmarking; Update applicable criteria/standards
- Deleting dated/irrelevant policies – and not replacing them
- Applying applicable quality control procedures – which may involve:
 - Compliance with organisational style guide; Adherence to organisation-wide QA protocols
- Introducing new policies – to address identified and legitimate emerging requirements/need
- Promoting awareness of policies in the workplace in a better manner/differently – so there is greater understanding regarding what is required
- Enhancing and/or altering monitoring of compliance with policies in the workplace – so users are more compelled to adhere to requirements of the policies
- Updating workplace databases and/or handbooks – so they contain the updated/current version of policies
- Incorporating new/revised policies into standard workplace protocols – in terms of, for example:
 - Inclusion into internal workplace training courses
 - Integrating into Induction and Orientation programs
- Circulating copies of the new/revised policy – using hard copies and electronic options

-
- Preparing/developing new or revised SOPs – to reflect the changed policy requirements
 - Organising and presenting relevant presentations – to all necessary levels/users within the organisation which may require/entail, as appropriate:
 - Introducing, explaining and demonstrating implementation of the policy,
 - Conducting supplementary information and training sessions
 - Holding staff briefings
 - Including articles in internal newsletters and posting on bulletin boards
 - Revising records management – to ensure all necessary information is captured and maintained for reference/use as required.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop and implement operational policies D1.HGE.CL7.14 D1.HGA.CL6.13 D2.TGA.CL6.10
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Develop operational policies - Administer and monitor operational policy - Conduct ongoing evaluation - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Develop operational policies		
Develop operational policies and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation	☐	☐
Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback	☐	☐
Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the policy	☐	☐
Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the policy	☐	☐
Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies	☐	☐
Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative	☐	☐
Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines	☐	☐
Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Administer and monitor operational policy		
Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities	☐	☐
Monitor performance indicators	☐	☐
Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements	☐	☐
Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy	☐	☐
Element 3: Conduct ongoing evaluation		
Review the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace	☐	☐
Monitor performance	☐	☐
Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly	☐	☐
Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest		
Unit of competency:	Develop and implement operational policies D1.HGE.CL7.14 D1.HGA.CL6.13 D2.TGA.CL6.10		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Investigates workplace needs and opportunities to guide development of operational policies and strategies for improvement and innovation in consultation with others	☐	☐	☐
Ensures operational policies align with enterprise goals/objectives and accommodate relevant internal and external factors	☐	☐	☐
Produces financially-sound resourcing plans and administrative frameworks/structures to support operational policies	☐	☐	☐
Communicates required details on operational policies to relevant others	☐	☐	☐
Develops and implements formal and structured evaluations system for operational policies	☐	☐	☐
Implements, monitors and reports on progress of operational policies in accordance with plans	☐	☐	☐
Responds effectively where operational policies show need for more resources	☐	☐	☐
Identifies problems with implementation of operational policies and adjusts accordingly	☐	☐	☐
Incorporates lessons learned from evaluation of operational policies in future planning and management	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Develop and implement operational policies	D1.HGE.CL7.14 D1.HGA.CL6.13 D2.TGA.CL6.10
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Develop operational policies						
Develop operational policies and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation						
Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback						
Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the policy						
Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the policy						
Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies						
Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative						
Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines						
Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Administer and monitor operational policy						
Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities						
Monitor performance indicators						
Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements						
Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy						
Element 3: Conduct ongoing evaluation						
Review the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace						
Monitor performance						
Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly						
Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

